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HOW TO WRITE A SKI AREA INCIDENT REPORT

What a ski patrol incident report should record, what to leave out, and a checklist for reviewing every report before it is filed.

BEFORE A REPORT IS FILED: THE REVIEW CHECKLIST

SAM's guidance recommends a dedicated final reviewer, such as the general manager or risk director, for every report. This is what they check.

- ☐ **Date, time and exact location** are filled in and specific
- ☐ **Every person involved** has a full name and phone number
- ☐ **Conditions** (weather, surface, visibility, traffic) are recorded
- ☐ **Witness statements** are attached in the witnesses' own words
- ☐ **Photos and a diagram** are attached
- ☐ **Times** of the call, arrival and departure are recorded
- ☐ **The care given** and how the patient left are recorded
- ☐ **No opinions, guesses or admissions** anywhere in the report
- ☐ **No blanks**: anything not known says so
- ☐ **No unclear abbreviations**
- ☐ **Red-flag incidents** (serious injury, a lift involved, a minor, a possible claim) are reported to management, the insurer and counsel as your protocol says
- ☐ **The writer and the reviewer** have signed, with the date

Incident number _____ Reviewed by _____ Date _____

WHAT EVERY REPORT SHOULD RECORD

THE BASICS

- **Date, time and exact location**: trail name, lift tower number, or a map point.
- **Who was involved**, with full names and phone numbers, and who responded.
- **Times**: when the call came in, when patrol arrived, when the patient left the hill.

THE CONDITIONS

- **Weather and visibility** at the time and place.
- **Snow surface**, the trail's grooming that day, and its status and difficulty rating.
- **Traffic** on the trail, and the skier count for the day if you track it.

- **Signs, markings and closures** nearby, as they actually were.

THE PEOPLE AND THE EQUIPMENT

- **The guest's equipment**: skis or board, helmet, rental or own.
- **Ability and activity** as the guest describes them, in their words.
- **Witnesses**, with names, phone numbers and their own statements.

THE CARE GIVEN

- **The assessment and care**, as your patrol's protocols require, with times.
- **How the patient left**: on their own, by toboggan to the patrol room, by ambulance, and where to.
- **Refusals** of care, recorded and signed as your protocol requires.

PHOTOS AND A DIAGRAM

- **Clear photos** of the scene, the surface and any signs, taken from where the guest came from.
- **A simple diagram** of the scene, marked with the direction of travel and where people were.

Sources: SAM magazine, "Report incidents properly". This guide is general information, not legal or medical advice; follow your patrol's protocols, your insurer and your counsel.

The full guide, with common questions: www.runmyresort.com/ski-area-incident-report-guide. Have your insurer and attorney review any procedure before you adopt it.